

# ADR-0003 — A dedicated nginx container serves the SPA and reverse-proxies the API

**ACCEPTED** Date: 2026-09-01 · Deciders: Nicolà Widmer

---

## Context

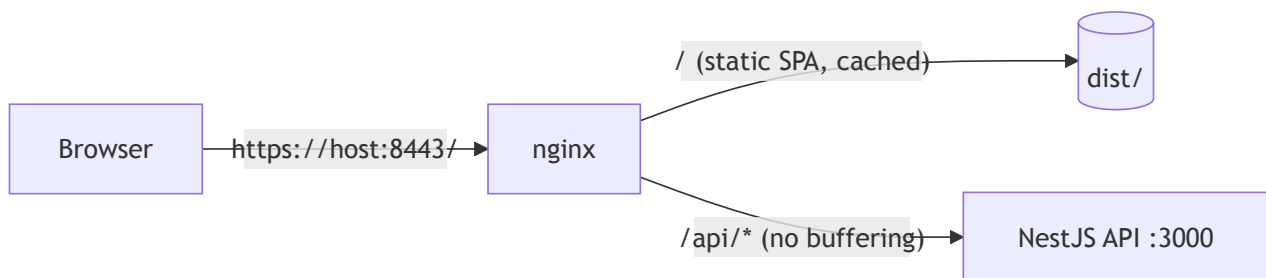
The built Angular app must be served and must reach the API. Audio is streamed with HTTP Range. Auth uses a cookie, so one origin avoids CORS.

## Options

1. **nginx container serves the SPA and proxies /api**
2. Express serves the static files
3. Separate origins (CDN + API domain, CORS)

## Decision

### Option 1.



nginx handles TLS, compression and caching by config. One origin keeps the cookie first-party (`SameSite=Lax`).

## Consequences

- Good: no CORS; static serving is off the Node process.
- Good: frontend and backend images build separately.
- Bad: one more image and config.
- Bad: upload limit (20 MB) set in both nginx and the API.
- Bad: proxy must not buffer streamed responses (`proxy_buffering off`).
- Rejected Express static: hand-written caching, backend rebuild on UI change.
- Rejected separate origins: CORS and a cross-site cookie.